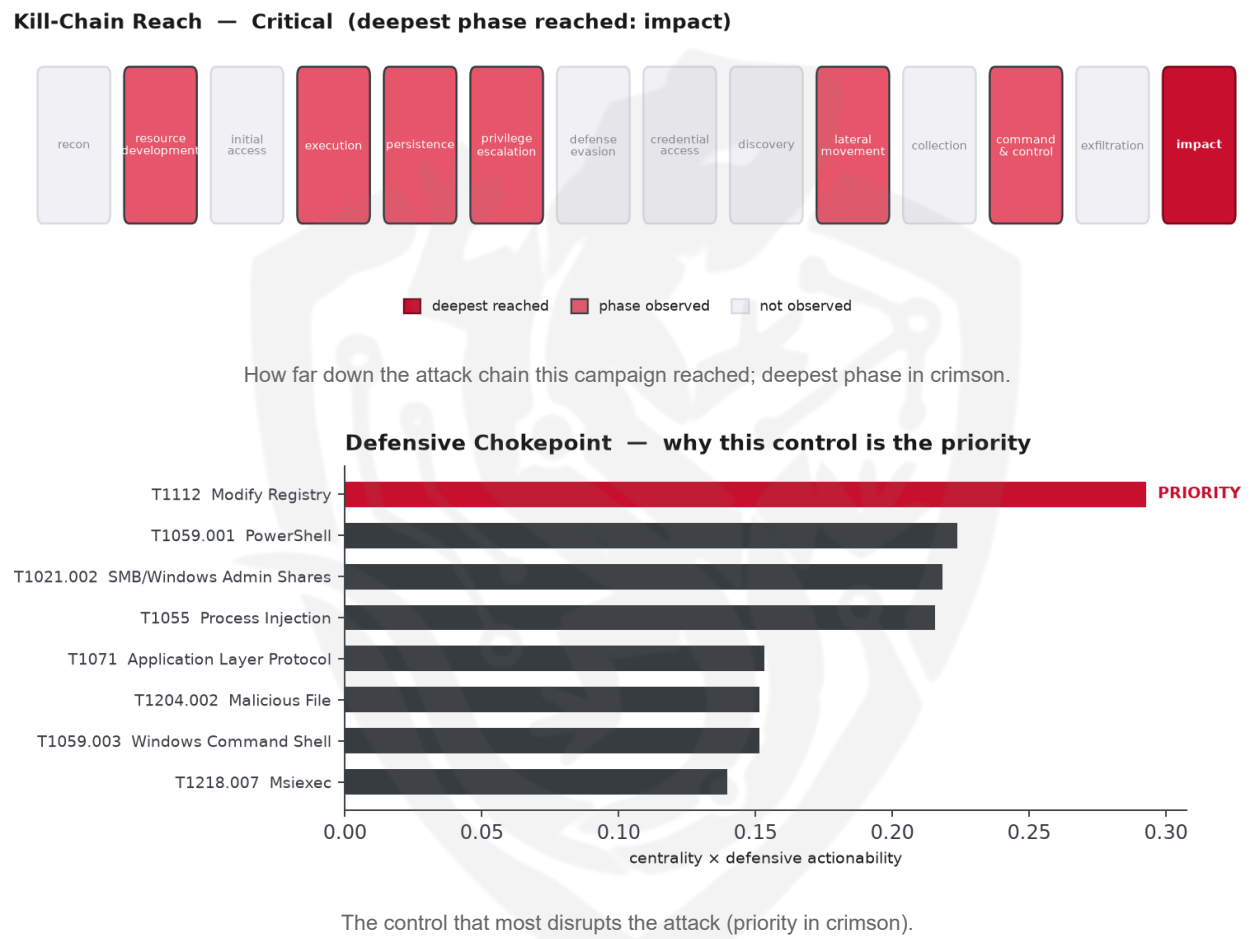


THREAT REPORT: VOID ARACHNE COUNTERFEIT INSTALLER CAMPAIGN

Visual Summary



Summary

Void Arachne is distributing counterfeit software installers that lead to system compromise. The campaign targets organizations in China across healthcare, manufacturing, technology, government, and education sectors. No specific malware family or CVE is identified in the source. Priority should be given to monitoring sensitive registry keys for modification and restricting registry-edit tools for unprivileged users.

Threat Overview

The source attributes this activity to Void Arachne. The malware family is listed as Data Insufficient, and no vulnerability (CVE) is disclosed. The observed victims are Chinese entities operating in the healthcare, manufacturing, technology, government, and education sectors.

Attack Chain and Priority Control

The observed techniques follow a multi-stage chain: deceptive download (T1204.002 Malicious File) → execution via Msiexec (T1218.007) → establishment of persistence with a scheduled task (T1053.005) → process injection (T1055) → modification of registry settings (T1112 Modify Registry) → lateral movement using SMB/Windows admin shares (T1021.002) and application-layer protocols (T1071) → service stop (T1489) and inhibition of system recovery (T1490).

Priority technique: T1112 Modify Registry

Priority control: Monitor sensitive registry keys for modification; restrict registry-edit tools for unprivileged users.

Infrastructure and Corroboration

The malicious infrastructure is hosted by ArossCloud Inc., CTG Server Limited, and Gnet Inc., as reported by the source pulse. Abuse.ch corroborates the presence of the ValleyRAT malware family on this infrastructure. AbuseIPDB does not flag any indicators at the 80 % confidence threshold.

Technical Appendix

Ground-truth telemetry from the source pulse; analytical scores are secondary and clearly labelled.

Observed Techniques (ATT&CK, expert-tagged by source)

- T1053.005 Scheduled Task
- T1036.005 Match Legitimate Resource Name or Location
- T1489 Service Stop
- T1204.002 Malicious File
- T1222.001 Windows Permissions
- T1071 Application Layer Protocol
- T1218.007 Msiexec
- T1583.001 Domains
- T1055 Process Injection
- T1021.002 SMB/Windows Admin Shares
- T1112 Modify Registry
- T1583.006 Web Services
- T1059.001 PowerShell
- T1562.001 Impair Defenses: Disable or Modify Tools
- T1571 Non-Standard Port
- T1059.003 Windows Command Shell
- T1574.002 Hijack Execution Flow
- T1105 Ingress Tool Transfer
- T1490 Inhibit System Recovery

Analytical Scores

- Priority technique (graph chokepoint): T1112 Modify Registry (centrality 0.3235).
- Operational risk: Critical (score 1.0, reaches impact).

Behavioral Signature Cluster

- Method: technique-overlap cosine vs 170 MITRE ATT&CK Groups (top overlap 0.4903; reference threshold $\tau = 0.6$).
- These are behavioural resemblances for defensive playbook cross-referencing, not an identity assessment. Where the source pulse names an actor, that attribution is authoritative; the overlaps below neither confirm nor contest it.

Nearest historical profiles by behavioural overlap (resemblance only):

Historical Profile	Behavioural Overlap
Rancor	0.4903
Machete	0.4757
Silence	0.4486
LazyScripter	0.4297
Storm-1811	0.4291

Enrichment Signal

- Highest AbuseIPDB confidence among IOCs: 0%.
- Malware families corroborated by abuse.ch: ValleyRAT.
- Note: enrichment raises the severity signal (an IOC at or above 80% AbuseIPDB confidence, or a confirmed malware-family hit). This is context, not a change to the source assessment.

Indicators of Compromise (defanged — non-clickable)

The network and file indicators observed in this activity are listed below for blocklisting:

Type	Indicator	Context
IP	161[.]248[.]87[.]157	AbuseIPDB 0% (HK) · ValleyRAT · AS400619 ArossCloud Inc.
IP	202[.]95[.]14[.]237	AbuseIPDB 0% (HK) · AS152194 CTG Server Limited
IP	103[.]156[.]25[.]35	AbuseIPDB 0% (HK) · AS400619 ArossCloud Inc.
IP	103[.]183[.]3[.]162	AbuseIPDB 0% (HK) · AS9294 Gnet Inc.

Type	Indicator	Context
Domain	iualef[.]net	
Domain	czijbh[.]net	
Domain	tbdqxq[.]net	
Domain	wfmwsj[.]net	
Domain	gehie246[.]com	
Domain	baidu-pan[.]com[.]cn	
Domain	steelseries-cn[.]com[.]cn	
Domain	pc-razerzone[.]com[.]cn	
Domain	yimxg25tiy[.]com	
Domain	cc8ttkv35b[.]com	
Domain	n7b8t85zsg[.]com	
Domain	kaspersky-lab[.]hl[.]cn	
Domain	calibre-ebook[.]com[.]cn	
Domain	app-microsoft-edge[.]com[.]cn	
Domain	sejda[.]hl[.]cn	
Domain	translate-youdao[.]hl[.]cn	

Type	Indicator	Context
Domain	zh-diskgenius[.]com[.]cn	
Domain	ocam-pc[.]com[.]cn	
Domain	cn-drawio[.]com[.]cn	
Domain	gw-sogou[.]com[.]cn	
Domain	mindmoster[.]com[.]cn	
Domain	euioxu[.]net	
Domain	oijfwe[.]net	
Domain	bxfh[.]tzcdq[.]cn	
Domain	tmsq[.]tzcdq[.]cn	
Domain	mebx78e02[.]com	
Domain	qwjre1487[.]com	
Domain	www[.]gehie246[.]com	
URL	hxxps://www[.]gehie246[.]com/712down	
URL	hxxp://www[.]gehie246[.]com/712down	
URL	hxxp://cc8ttkv35b[.]com/7qinst	
URL	hxxp://gehie246[.]com/712down	
URL	hxxp://n7b8t85zsg[.]com/ins711	
URL	hxxp://yimxg25tiy[.]com/73inst	
Hash	5251b98614acffe5c856f4039ca03da3	

Type	Indicator	Context
Hash	c80ed6716e89d4862f28ebbc130ec5aa362d b963	

Reputation by AbuseIPDB · malware attribution by abuse.ch · Geo/ASN data by IP2Location LITE.

Flame Cell // Adversary Pivot [BETA]

BETA. A hypothetical tabletop projection, anchored to documented ATT&CK behaviour and technique co-occurrence across 170 tracked groups. It is not a prediction; treat it as a war-game prompt and review before acting. Spot a pivot that looks wrong? norbert@salacti.com

- **Control applied:** T1112 Modify Registry (persistence)
- **Observed here:** T1112 Modify Registry was the only persistence technique observed in this campaign, so the pivot is projected from cross-actor behaviour.
- **Projected pivot:** T1543 Create or Modify System Process (persistence)
- **Basis:** of the 14+ groups that use Modify Registry, this pairing runs 2.8x above base rate, a disproportionately-coupled move rather than the obvious one.

With T1112 Modify Registry blocked, Void Arachne could preserve the same objective by pivoting to T1543 Create or Modify System Process, a technique disproportionately paired with it across tracked groups. Defensive countermeasure: Restrict service/daemon creation to admins; monitor service and driver installs.

Also plausible (same tactic): T1547 Boot or Logon Autostart Execution (n=17, lift 1.7), T1505 Server Software Component (n=11, lift 2.0)

Detection and hardening for the pivot (T1543 Create or Modify System Process)

- **Telemetry:** Windows Security / System log; Sysmon
- **Detect:**
 - System 7045 (new service installed); Security 4697 (service installed)
 - Sysmon 1 for sc.exe / services created; unusual ImagePath or user-context services
 - Registry writes under HKLM\SYSTEM\CurrentControlSet\Services
- **Harden:**
 - Restrict service creation to admins; application control on service binaries
 - Baseline installed services and alert on new/anomalous ones
- **MITRE:** M1047 Audit, M1028 Operating System Configuration, M1026 Privileged Account Management · DS0019 Service, DS0024 Windows Registry, DS0009 Process